Launch Control XL 3 — Drum Machines Comparison

	1 · 808	2 · 909	3 · 707	4 · LinnDrum	5 · DMX	6 · SP-1200	7 · Synth	8 · Rumble
Row 1 Reverb	CC 13 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 14 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 15 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 16 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 17 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 18 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 19 **Reverb** Left = dry. Turning right adds more reverb in a growing room.	CC 20 **Reverb** Left = dry. Only on the 909; the rumble has its own reverb.
Row 2 Decay	CC 21 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 22 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 23 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 24 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 25 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 26 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 27 **Decay** Right = full length, turning left makes it shorter and tighter.	CC 28 **Decay** Right = full length, left = shorter. Only the 909; the rumble stays.
Row 3 Soft ↔ Hard	CC 29 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 30 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 31 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 32 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 33 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 34 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 35 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.	CC 36 **Soft ↔ Hard** Middle = original. Left = attack + lowpass: soft, round, no click. Right = saturation: rougher, more punch.
Fader Level	CC 5 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 6 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 7 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 8 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 9 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 10 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 11 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation	CC 12 **Level** 0–1, slightly quieter with saturation
Buttons 1 Variant	CC 37 **Variant** Decay short → long (Tone 25)	CC 38 **Variant** 4 samples	CC 39 **Variant** 2 samples	CC 40 **Variant** only 1 sample	CC 41 **Variant** 3 samples	CC 42 **Variant** Samples 1, 5, 9, 13 of 14	CC 43 **Variant** Pitch drop 24/36/48/12	CC 44 **Variant** Rumble pitch E/G/D/A
Buttons 2 Instrument	CC 45 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 46 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 47 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 48 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 49 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 50 **Instrument** Kick → Snare → Clap → Closed Hat → Open Hat	CC 51 —	CC 52 —

Set both button rows to **Momentary** in Components: each press steps one position forward, and it wraps around at the end. After re-evaluating, everything starts at Kick, variant 1. Rhythms: kick on every quarter note, snare and clap on beats 2 and 4, closed hat on sixteenths, open hat on the offbeats.

The machines (kicks)

1 · Roland TR-808 (1980) soft · deep · long

Analog sine boom with a pitch drop, almost no click, long decay. Deep house, hip-hop, electro, trap. Sounds huge on bass-heavy headphones, almost invisible on small speakers.

2 · Roland TR-909 (1983) medium-hard · punch · click

The techno and house standard: a short click at the front, a strong body, medium decay. Chicago/Detroit, Berlin techno, tech house. Takes a lot of saturation.

3 · Roland TR-707 (1985) medium · dry · short

Digital samples, tight and short, little depth. Early Chicago house and Italo, 80s feel. Good for layering over an 808.

4 · LinnDrum (1982) soft-medium · acoustic · short

Sampled real bass drum, dull and dry. 80s pop, synthpop, early house tracks. More “drum kit” than “machine”.

5 · Oberheim DMX (1981) medium-hard · punchy · dry

Short, hard hit with little decay. Electro, early hip-hop (Run-DMC), Detroit electro.

6 · E-mu SP-1200 (1987) warm · grainy · rough

No kick instrument of its own, but a sampler: 12-bit gives the sound a warm, slightly dusty grain. Golden-age hip-hop, New York house, garage.

7 · Synth kick (Strudel, own sound) clean · deep · soft to hard

Sine with a fast pitch drop plus a tiny noise click, the way 808 and 909 are built at their core. Minimal, deep house. Variant = how far the pitch drops: more drop = more “punch”.

8 · Rumble kick (Strudel, own sound) hard · dark · techno

909 plus a low, reverb-smeared rumble on the sixteenths between the kicks. Typical of Berlin/warehouse techno and hard groove. Variant = pitch of the rumble (match it to the key).

Variants (button row 1), for kick

Each press steps to the next variant: 1 → 2 → 3 → 4 → 1. For snare, clap and hats, the variants are simply samples 1–4 of the machine (fewer samples repeat).

Column	1	2	3	4
1 · 808	Decay 00: short thump	Decay 25	Decay 50	Decay 75: long boom
	The 808 samples were recorded with the original's two controls: Tone (click content) and Decay (length). Here Tone is fixed at 25.			
2 · 909	Sample 1	Sample 2	Sample 3	Sample 4
	Four recordings of the 909 kick with different settings (tune, attack, decay); which exactly is not labeled in the sample collection.			
3 · 707	Bass drum 1	Bass drum 2	like 1	like 2
4 · LinnDrum	only one sample, the button changes nothing			
5 · DMX	Bass drum 1	Bass drum 2	Bass drum 3	like 1
6 · SP-1200	Sample 1	Sample 5	Sample 9	Sample 13
	Library kicks from the sampler, very different from each other; what they share is the 12-bit grain.			
7 · Synth	Pitch drop 24 st: round	36 st: more punch	48 st: hard click attack	12 st: nearly pure sine, very soft
8 · Rumble	Rumble on E	on G	on D	on A
	Set the rumble's pitch to the track's root note, otherwise it hums out of tune against the bassline.			